

JESSICA L.S. OLSEN

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SUMMARY

Strategic grantmaker and operator with 11 years stewarding high-trust partnerships among public agencies, nonprofits, and communities in California. Managed \$140M climate grant portfolio, owning grant lifecycle from capacity building to impact measurement. Energized by building teams, systems, and processes to maximize impact.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Builder | RegScout | <https://beyond-markets.vercel.app/> 2025–Present

Regulatory and funding intelligence for mission-driven investors and founders (beta)

- **Shipped working beta** iterating with early users across the climate and impact space

Investor | Stanford GSB Impact Fund | Stanford, CA 2025–2026

Student-led impact fund investing at the intersection of financial return and measurable social impact

- **Awarded the inaugural Kahn-Olsen Award** (named after my partner and myself) for Best Presentation

Director of Community Strategies & Resources | Valley Air District | Fresno, Ca 2021–2025

Public health agency; led \$140M climate and pollution reduction grant portfolio with interdisciplinary, interagency team

- **Owned the full grant lifecycle for a \$140M climate portfolio:** designed solicitation process, impact measurement frameworks (cost-per-ton, adoption rates, health KPIs), tracked reporting; reduced 8,000 tons of emissions
- **Authored and won \$1M competitive U.S. EPA grant:** funded training and capacity building for community-based nonprofits distributing 20,000 air purifiers through their trust networks
- **Designed and ran sustained community engagement:** hundreds of town halls, advisory groups, and neighborhood meetings; mapped and managed relationships leading to more effective grantmaking
- **Designed participatory budgeting tool for California Climate Investment funds:** turned community concerns into operational and funding decisions for grant operations in environmental justice communities
- **Built and led a new community engagement team from the ground up:** hired, trained, and managed staff and contractors against a \$12M annual operating budget
- **Translated complex technical evidence:** communicated public health, environmental, and emissions data, into clear, credible public health messaging for 4M residents of the San Joaquin Valley
- **Founded inaugural Community Engagement Summit:** best practice now used across other California air districts

Program Manager, Air Quality Analysis, Research & Modeling | Valley Air District | Fresno, Ca 2019–2021

- **Oversaw the District's wildfire forecasting and prevention/response function:** approved Rx fires, led smoke-inhalation public health communications, worked directly with USFS, NPS, CalFire, and BLM during wildfires
- **Co-led federal air quality and climate pollution compliance planning:** coordinated state and federal regulators on atmospheric modeling and scenario planning for pollution reduction measures
- **Built research partnerships** with UC Davis, Stanford, Texas A&M, and national labs to expand the District's evidence base across air quality, climate, and community health

Innovation + Collaboration Principal | Doolittle Institute | Niceville, FL 2018–2019

Nonprofit connecting government, academia, and industry for Air Force Research Lab; 1 year during spouse's military orders

- **Founded Think Thursdays**, a recurring convening connecting founders, researchers, and government leaders
- **Designed and launched cross-sector innovation initiatives** reaching 650+ researchers, engineers, and military

Specialist & Air Quality Analysis and Research Supervisor | Valley Air District | Fresno, Ca 2014–2018

- **Supervised team of scientists and analysts** producing the technical evidence base for air quality regulation
- **Led technology evaluation** that drove industry-wide adoption of emissions-reduction equipment across California; demonstrated how regulator-led technical analysis can shift industry behavior at scale
- **Key strategist on federal air quality compliance planning** partnering with state and federal regulators

EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business M.S. in Management	2026
<i>Certificate: Public Management and Social Innovation</i>	
<i>Coursework: public policy ethics, political economy, impact investing, data & decisions, strategy & marketing</i>	
UC Irvine Henry Samueli School of Engineering M.S. in Biomedical Engineering	2014
UCLA Henry Samueli School of Engineering B.S. in Bioengineering	2011
<i>Two peer-reviewed publications in Biomacromolecules (co-first author, 2013)</i>	

LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

- **AAPCA Best Practices Award** — National award for community-facing air pollution work at the Valley Air District
- **Director of the Year (2024)** — awarded to top-performing director at Valley Air District
- **Certified Professional Facilitator** — experienced moderating executive and multi-stakeholder sessions
- **Drum Major, UCLA Marching Band (2010–2012)** — led 250-member ensemble before 80,000+ audiences

THE FUN STUFF

- **Military Spouse-turned-Commercial Pilot Wife** — I know more than I should about the FAA and air regulations.
- **Marathon Runner** — Striving (and striding) to qualify for Boston, but prefer trail running anyway.
- **Fashionably Early** — Being late makes me anxious.